MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS • REGULATORY GOVERNANCE (MFS-GOV-01)

Reasonable Adjustments & Special Consideration Policy

Ensuring fair, accessible assessment conditions for neurodiverse, dyslexic, and disabled Functional Skills candidates without compromising qualification standards.

Document Reference	MFS-GOV-01	**Effective Date**	11 November 2026
Quality & Centre Lead	Abdul (Head of Centre)	**Regulatory Alignment**	Ofqual Conditions G6 & G7 / Equality Act 2010

1. Policy Purpose & Scope

Master Functional Skills designs every learning resource, diagnostic check, and assessment preparation pathway from the ground up for neurodiverse, dyslexic, dyscalculic, and adult returner candidates. This policy sets out transparent arrangements for requesting, evidencing, approving, and recording Reasonable Adjustments and Special Considerations across Entry Level, Level 1, and Level 2 Functional Skills qualifications (Mathematics, English, and Digital Functional Skills) aligned with Open Awards, Pearson Edexcel, and City & Guilds regulations.

- **Reasonable Adjustments:** Agreed prior to an assessment sitting to reduce substantial disadvantage caused by a disability, neurodivergent profile, or long-term medical condition.
- **Special Consideration:** A post-assessment adjustment requested when temporary illness, bereavement, or unforeseen disruption beyond the candidate's control materially affects exam performance.
- **Qualification Integrity Principle:** Adjustments remove unfair barriers to access while preserving the core DfE Functional Skills subject content and assessment reliability.

2. Permitted Access Arrangements & Evidence Thresholds

Access arrangements are tailored to the learner's normal way of working during Master Functional Skills tuition and practice mocks, supported by appropriate diagnostic or medical evidence:

Adjustment Category	Typical Provision	Evidence Required	Notice Period
Up to 25% Extra Time	15 mins per hour added in XAMS / onscreen timer	Educational psychologist / specialist assessor report, EHCP, or formal dyslexia/ADHD evidence + normal way of working log	15 Working Days
Supervised Rest Breaks	Stop-the-clock supervised breaks (candidate stays in camera view)	Medical letter, neurodiversity profile, anxiety/fatigue documentation, or tutor normal-way-of-working	15 Working Days

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Onscreen Accessibility & Overlays	Cream/blue screen tint, zoom magnification, high-contrast layout	Learner self-declaration + documented use on MFS Dyslexia Readability Toolbar	7 Working Days
Computer Reader / Human Reader	Permitted in Maths & Digital Skills (strictly prohibited in English Reading)	Formal literacy / visual impairment assessment + Awarding Body pre-approval	20 Working Days
Special Consideration	Post-exam tariff review by Awarding Organisation	Medical certificate, hospital note, bereavement record, or verified technical incident log	Within 5 Working Days Post-Exam

3. Application Deadlines, Portal Submission & Audit Trail

To allow timely submission via the Awarding Organisation portal (e.g., Open Awards Portal / XAMS onscreen settings), candidates and tutors follow strict pre-exam timelines:

- **Minimum Notice Window:** Candidates must declare access needs at registration and submit supporting evidence at least 15 working days before the requested online or paper exam sitting.
- **Centre-Delegated vs Awarding-Body Approval:** Adjustments permitted under centre-delegated authority (such as onscreen colour tinting or supervised rest breaks) are logged internally by the Quality Nominee; extra time, human readers, scribes, or exemptions are submitted to the Awarding Organisation prior to scheduling.
- **Special Consideration Window:** Applications for Special Consideration must be submitted with corroborating evidence within 5 working days following the affected assessment sitting.
- **Secure Record Keeping:** Diagnostic evidence and approval confirmations are stored in encrypted UK GDPR-compliant records for a minimum of 3 years for regulatory audit.

Document Control & Annual Governance Sign-Off

Approved By (Head of Centre & Quality Nominee):	Abdul — Master Functional Skills
Approval & Publication Date:	11 November 2026 (Version 2026.11)
Next Mandatory Annual Review Date:	11 November 2027 (or immediately upon Ofqual / Awarding Body update)